

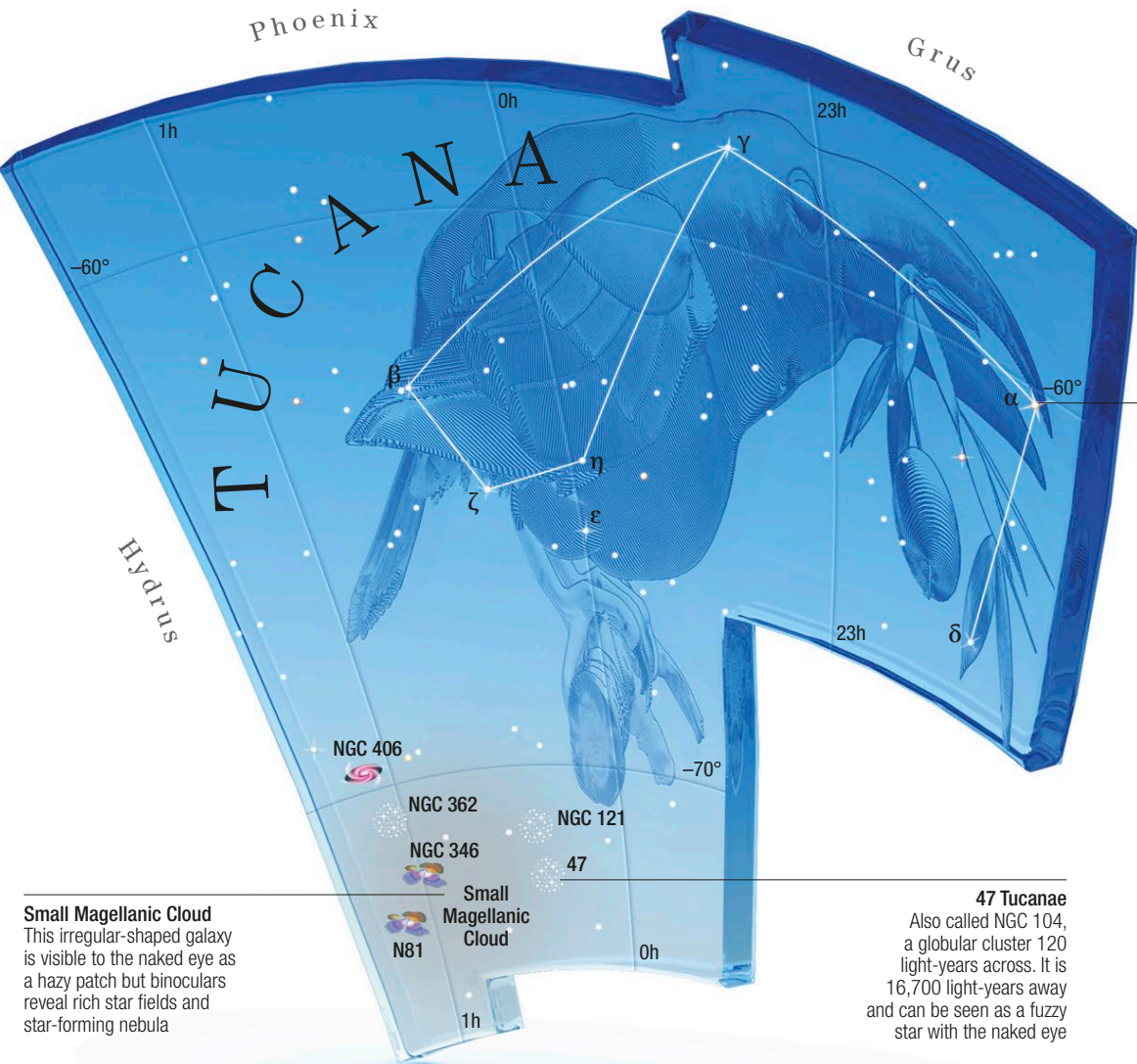
# TUCANA

## THE TOUCAN

THIS CONSTELLATION DEPICTING THE TOUCAN, A LARGE-BEAKED TROPICAL BIRD, WAS INTRODUCED TO THE FAR SOUTHERN SKY IN THE LATE 16TH CENTURY. IT IS FAINT AND HAS AN INDISTINCT PATTERN, BUT IT IS HOST TO SOME SIGNIFICANT CELESTIAL OBJECTS.

Located south of Phoenix and Grus, west of Hydrus, and southwest of the bright star Achernar in Eridanus, Tucana is one of 12 constellations devised by Dutch navigators Pieter Dirkszoon Keyser and Frederick de Houtman. It was first depicted on a globe by fellow Dutchman Petrus Plancius in 1598. None of the constellation's stars is named and there are no legends associated with it. However, Tucana

is notable for two important features: the Small Magellanic Cloud (SMC) and 47 Tucanae. The SMC is the smaller of the Milky Way's two major satellite galaxies (the other is the Large Magellanic Cloud, in Dorado and Mensa). A compact globular cluster, 47 Tucanae (also known as NGC 104) contains several million stars and is the second-brightest globular cluster visible from Earth in the night sky.



### KEY DATA

|                               |                              |
|-------------------------------|------------------------------|
| <b>Size ranking</b>           | 48                           |
| <b>Brightest stars</b>        | Alpha (α) 2.8, Gamma (γ) 4.0 |
| <b>Genitive</b>               | Tucanae                      |
| <b>Abbreviation</b>           | Tuc                          |
| <b>Highest in sky at 10pm</b> | September–November           |
| <b>Fully visible</b>          | 14°N–90°S                    |



CHART 2

### MAIN STARS

|                                                                                         |                                                                                                     |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Alpha (α) Tucanae</b>                                                                | Orange giant                                                                                        |
|  2.9 |  200 light-years |

### DEEP-SKY OBJECTS

|                                         |                                                       |
|-----------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>47 Tucanae</b>                       | Globular cluster, also known as NGC 104               |
| <b>NGC 121</b>                          | Globular cluster in the Small Magellanic Cloud        |
| <b>NGC 346</b>                          | Star cluster and nebula in the Small Magellanic Cloud |
| <b>NGC 362</b>                          | Globular cluster                                      |
| <b>NGC 406</b>                          | Spiral galaxy                                         |
| <b>Small Magellanic Cloud (NGC 292)</b> | Irregular galaxy in orbit around the Milky Way        |
| <b>N81</b>                              | Star-forming nebula in the Small Magellanic Cloud     |

**Alpha (α) Tucanae**  
Tucana's brightest star, this orange giant marks the end of the bird's beak. It is about 37 times the Sun's width and 424 its luminosity

▽ **NGC 346**  
Located within the Small Magellanic Cloud, this star-forming region contains more than 2,500 infant stars. A cluster of dozens of hot blue stars lies at its heart. Energy from these stars is sculpting the surrounding nebula. Other newborn stars, which have not yet started the nuclear fusion process that will make them shine, are within the nebula.

